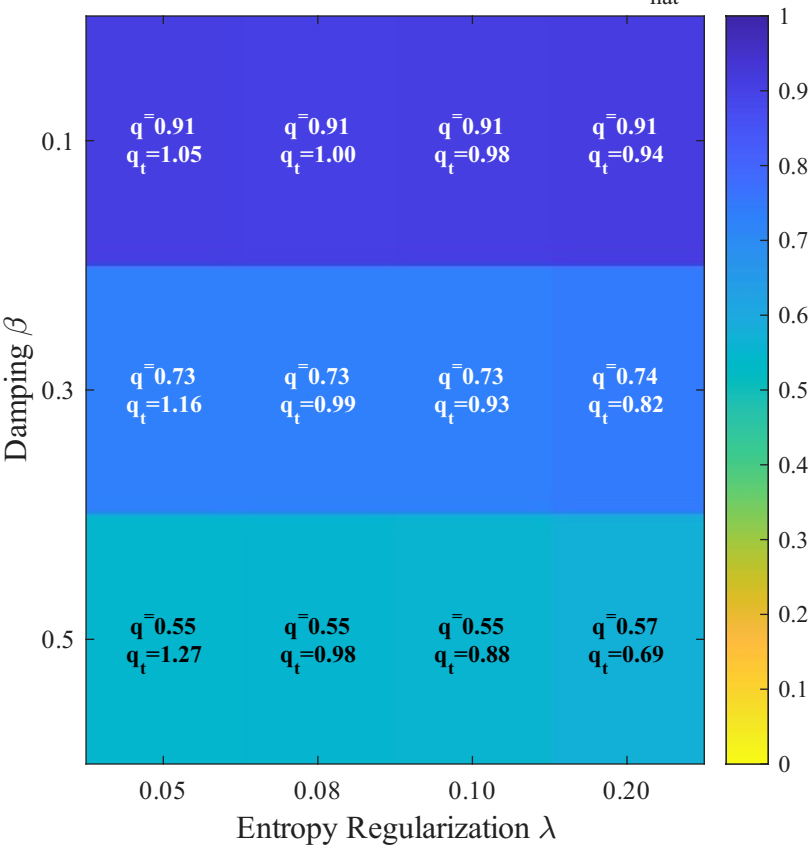


(a) Proposed Empirical Contraction Rate q_{hat} (b) Scalability of Convergence Rounds R vs N 